TOUCH ENGLISH™
SPEAK WITH CONFIDENCE

STUDENT WORKBOOK · LEVEL 2

# Explain a Problem to a Service Provider

Explain | PPF | Service Desk Role-play

Name: _____ Date: _____

## SLIDE 02 Today's goal

By the end of this lesson, I can:

**Tell a repair shop, clinic or bank when a problem started, what is wrong now, what you have tried and what you need, then answer their questions.**

**WHO** You live in Johor Bahru and use your phone every day for work calls and your e-wallet. You bought it 11 months ago at a phone shop in Taman Pelangi, and you have the receipt.

**SITUATION** Last Saturday it switched off by itself in the middle of a video call. Now it switches off three or four times a day, at any time. This morning it went off twice at 60% battery. You've tried a new charger, but it still happens.

**NEED** It is Wednesday, and you are back at the shop. They need the facts for the job sheet. You need the phone back by Saturday, you want the price before they repair it, and you want to ask about the warranty.

**GOAL** Explain the problem in order (when it started → what is wrong now → what you need next → what is still open), so the shop can write the job sheet.

## SLIDE 03 Try it first

Mei Ling asks: "Your phone switched off again? Take it back to the shop at lunch. What will you tell them?" Say something for 30 seconds. Then note what you said.

## SLIDE 04 A good message

Siti's answer. Mark where each part starts.

Hi, I have a problem with my phone. It started last Saturday: it switched off by itself in the middle of a video call. Now it switches off three or four times a day. For example, this morning it went off twice at 60% battery. I've already tried a new charger, but it still happens. I use it for work calls, so I need it back by Saturday. Can you check it today and tell me the price before you repair it? One thing I'm not sure about: is it still under warranty? I'm asking because I bought it here 11 months ago. Here's the receipt.

P WHEN IT STARTED _____

P WHAT IS WRONG NOW _____

F WHAT I NEED NEXT _____

! STILL OPEN _____

## SLIDE 05 Organise it

Kumar tells a doctor about his cough. When it started → what is wrong now → what I need next → still open.

- ☐ It started on Monday night with a sore throat. The next morning, I had a bad cough.
- ☐ Now I cough all night. For example, last night I woke up four times. I've taken cough syrup, but it's still bad.
- ☐ One thing I'm not sure about: can I still play futsal on Saturday?
- ☐ I talk to customers all day, so I need something that works quickly. Can I have an MC for today?

Write the letter: **P** = When it started · **P** = What is wrong now · **F** = What I need next · **!** = Still open

## SLIDE 06 Useful language

Tick the expressions you used today.

### WHEN IT STARTED

- [ ] It started last …
- [ ] About … ago, it …
- [ ] The first time was …
- [ ] It happened when I …

### WHAT IS WRONG NOW

- [ ] Now it … about … times a day.
- [ ] For example, …
- [ ] I've already tried …
- [ ] …, but it still …

### WHAT I NEED NEXT

- [ ] I use it for …, so I need it …
- [ ] I need it back by …
- [ ] Can you check it and …?
- [ ] Please call me before you …

### STILL OPEN

- [ ] One thing I'm not sure about: …
- [ ] I'm asking because …
- [ ] Is it still under warranty?
- [ ] How much will it cost?

### CHECK

- [ ] Is that clear?
- [ ] Shall I say that again?
- [ ] Can you read it back to me?

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## SLIDE 07 Connect the ideas

Choose the connector and write the new sentence.

1. I use my phone for work calls. [ because / so / For example, ] I need it back by Saturday.

   _____

2. It switches off three or four times a day. [ but / For example, / because ] This morning it went off twice at 60% battery.

   _____

3. I've already tried a new charger. [ For example, / so / but ] It still switches off.

   _____

4. I'm asking about the warranty. [ but / so / because ] I bought the phone 11 months ago.

   _____

## SLIDE 08 Time control

Circle the right form. Why?

1. It _____ last Saturday, in the middle of a video call. (When it started, with a time)
   - ○ has start
   - ○ starting
   - ○ started
2. Now it _____ off three or four times a day. (What happens now, again and again)
   - ○ switches
   - ○ switching
   - ○ switch
3. I _____ already tried a new charger. (What you have tried, up to now)
   - ○ has
   - ○ am
   - ○ have
4. I changed the charger, but the problem still _____. (Not fixed yet)
   - ○ happens
   - ○ happen
   - ○ happening

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## SLIDE 09 What I've tried: already … but still

For what you have done up to now, with no exact time, use have / has + past participle, often with already. Add but … still for a problem that is not fixed. With an exact past time, use the past.

I **'ve already tried** a new charger.

I **'ve restarted** it twice, **but** it **still** switches off.

I **haven't changed** any settings.

It **started last Saturday**. (an exact time → past)

SLIDE 10

# Build your message

Fill each part with your own idea. You will use the same parts in the task.

P

WHEN IT STARTED

Hi, I have a problem with my … It started …

P

WHAT IS WRONG NOW

Now it … For example, … I've already tried …, but it still …

F

WHAT I NEED NEXT

I use it for …, so I need it back by … Can you …?

!

STILL OPEN

One thing I'm not sure about: …? I'm asking because …

SLIDE 11

# Service Desk Role-play

The customer explains a problem from a mixed-up card. The service person cannot see it: they fill the job sheet, then answer the customer's question.

1. Round 1 (3:00). Service person: 'How can I help?' Customer: when it started → now → tried → need, then ask.
2. Service person: listen and fill the job sheet, then ask about empty lines (mark '?') and answer. Customer: say it back.
3. Round 2 (2:00): service people move one seat. Same card to the new service person, shorter. Next column.
4. Round 3 (2:00), frames closed: customers turn the workbook over. Then swap roles and do rounds 1–3 again.

**Card 1 · The fridge**

**Card 2 · The new glasses**

**Card 3 · The e-wallet top-up**

**Card 4 · The car brakes**

Job sheet

| | ROUND 1 | ROUND 2 | ROUND 3 |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Started (when)** | | | |
| **Wrong now + example** | | | |
| **Already tried** | | | |
| **Need, by when + question** | | | |

My partner's question or concern, and what I answered:

## SLIDE 12 Respond

Amy asks. Write a short answer to one of these.

1. When did you buy the phone, and do you have the receipt?
2. Does it only switch off when you use the camera?
3. If it needs a new battery, can we change it straight away?

Start with: **I bought it here … ago, and … · No. For example, … · Please call me first and …**

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## SLIDE 13 Transfer

At work, your laptop cannot print. It started on Monday, after the laptop restarted for an update. Other people can print, but you can't. You've already restarted the laptop twice. You need 30 quotations for a customer meeting at 10 a.m. tomorrow. Tell Ali in IT: when it started → what is wrong now → what you need → one question.

**Hi Ali. It started on Monday: … · Now I can't …, but other people … · I've already …, but I still can't … · I need … by … One thing I'm not sure about: …?**

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## SLIDE 14 Did I do it?

Be honest. Tick what you did in the task.

- [ ] Says when the problem started and what is wrong now, with one example.
- [ ] Says what they have already tried and that the problem is still there.
- [ ] Says what they need next and by when, and asks the question that is still open.

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SLIDE 15

# Feedback: how can I improve?

Circle one number for each area. 1 = I need help · 2 = OK · 3 = Good

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| When it started and what is wrong now | ○ 1 | ○ 2 | ○ 3 |
| What I have tried | ○ 1 | ○ 2 | ○ 3 |
| What I need and my question | ○ 1 | ○ 2 | ○ 3 |
| Useful expressions | ○ 1 | ○ 2 | ○ 3 |
| Confidence | ○ 1 | ○ 2 | ○ 3 |

**My improvement action:** Next time, I will _____.

WE BELIEVE IN THE POWER OF PRACTICAL SPEAKING TO INSPIRE CONFIDENCE

**After class: open the After class review**

SLIDE 11

# Listener cards: fold or cut

Only the listener looks at a card. It says what to find out and write in the note.

**Card 1 · The fridge**
You answer the phone at the service centre. Write the job sheet. Ask about an empty line. Then answer the question: the warranty is 2 years, so the visit is free. The technician comes from 2 to 5 p.m.

**Card 2 · The new glasses**
You work at an optical shop in Mount Austin. Write the job sheet. Ask about an empty line. Then answer the question: the check is free, and if something is wrong we change it free within 30 days.

**Card 3 · The e-wallet top-up**
You answer the e-wallet helpline. Write the job sheet. Ask about an empty line. Then answer the question: it will be fixed within 24 hours, and we will send an SMS.

**Card 4 · The car brakes**
You work at a car workshop in Skudai. Write the job sheet. Ask about an empty line. Then answer the question: please don't drive it; leave it here now, and we will phone you when it is ready.

SLIDE 11

# Speaker cards: fold or cut

Only the speaker looks at a card. The listener keeps this page folded.

**Card 1 · The fridge**

Tried: cleaned it; off for 1 hour · Question: still under warranty? (bought 20 months ago) · Now: top part not cold · Need: a technician by Thursday (open house Saturday) · Started: Sunday night · Example: milk went sour in a day

**Card 2 · The new glasses**

Need: please check the lenses this week · Started: 2 weeks ago, when I got them · Question: do I pay again? · Example: yesterday I stopped work at 11 a.m. · Tried: worn them daily; old ones OK · Now: headache after 1 hour at work

**Card 3 · The e-wallet top-up**

Example: couldn't pay at the mamak on Tuesday · Started: Monday, topped up RM100 · Question: how long? · Tried: logged in again; waited 2 days · Now: bank took RM100; wallet shows RM0 · Need: RM100 in the wallet by Friday

**Card 4 · The car brakes**

Question: can I still drive it? · Started: last Monday, on the way home · Need: the car by Thursday, 6 p.m. · Example: this morning at the traffic lights · Tried: checked the tyres, all fine · Now: loud noise every time I brake